Shufan Yu

Clear Water Bay, Sai Kung District, Hong Kong SAR, China
+852 94191780 | shufan.yu1@gamil.com | https://shufanyu.github.io/

EDUCATION & EXPERIENCE

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST) **Hong Kong SAR, China**
Postdoctoral researcher Sep. 2026

- **Brain, Language, and Computation Lab, Advisor: Prof. Ping Li**
- **Research:** Biosignal-Powered Adaptive VR Learning with GenAI

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (PolyU) **Hong Kong SAR, China**
Postdoctoral fellow
Recipient of PolyU Postdoc Matching Fund Scheme Sep. 2024 to Aug. 2026

- **Brain, Language, and Computation Lab, Advisor: Prof. Ping Li**
- **Research:** Neural coupling during collaborative learning in VR; Biosignal adaptative learning

Arizona State University (ASU) **Tempe, AZ, USA**
Visiting Scholar in Cognitive Psychology
Funded by Chinese Scholarship Council Nov. 2021 to Dec. 2022

- **Embodied Games Lab, Advisor: Prof. Mina C. Johnson-Glenberg**
- **Project:** Haptic Titration experiment; Tuned Mass Damper simulation

Central China Normal University (CCNU) **Wuhan, China**
Ph.D. in Educational Technology Sep. 2019 to Dec. 2023

- **Virtual Learning Lab, Advisor: Prof. Qingtang Liu**
- **Thesis:** "Research on the Construction and Application of a Virtual-real Mixed Junior High School Circuit Experiment based on the Theory of Embodied Cognition"

Central China Normal University (CCNU) **Wuhan, China**
M.Sc. in Educational Technology Sep. 2016 to June. 2019

- **Virtual Learning Lab, Advisor: Prof. Qingtang Liu**
- **Thesis:** "Research on the AR-based magnetism experiment"

Yancheng Teachers University **Yancheng, China**
B.Eng. in Digital Media Technology Sep. 2012 to June. 2016

RESEARCH

Research Interest

- XR-based learning
- Cognitive neuroscience
- Embodied cognition
- Pedagogical agent/avatar
- AI powered adaptive learning
- Computational thinking

Research Project

Research on the neural dynamics of visual attention in VR environment—— self-project
PI Sep 2024- Sep 2026

- Design and develop a portable solution for motion capture in VR
- Align motion, neural, and eye tracking data, sound data solution
- Conduct fNIRS experiment in VR experiment

Research on the effect of level of embodiment and external representation of a virtual real mixed electric circuit on students' learning performance— funded by excellent doctoral dissertation project of CCNU **PI Sep. 2022 - June. 2023**

- Conduct a 2*2 quasi-experiment to investigate the effects of embodiment and representation of an AR-based electric circuit learning tool on students' learning
- Collect the quantitative and qualitative data
- Data analysis (t-test, ANCOVA, Content analysis)

Research on Key Technologies of constructing Virtual and Real Fusion Experimental Environment — funded by excellent doctoral dissertation project of CCNU **PI Sep. 2021 - June. 2022**

- Develop an Assembleable AR-based circuit experiment
- Proposed an AR-based circuit calculation algorithm
- Visualizing current direction of AR circuit
- Implementing the auto-generation of circuit graph
- Designing the personalized feedback

Research on the development and implementation of an AR-based magnetism learning tool — funded by innovation project of graduate students of CCNU **PI Sep. 2019 - June. 2020**

- Investigate the key technology to develop a virtual-real mixed magnetism learning tool
- Conduct a quasi-experiment to explore its effects on students' learning
- Data analysis
- Paper writing and publishing

Research on development system for virtual and real fusion experiments of multimodal natural interaction — funded by self-determined researcher funds of CCNU from the colleges' basic research and operation of Ministry of Education in China. **Co-I June. 2018- June. 2020**

- Design, develop, and assessment some AR/VR-based instructional virtual experiments

Key Technology Research and Demonstration of Tujia music culture digital protection and display — funded by Chinese National Key Technology Research and Development Program of the Ministry of Science and Technology of China. **Graduate Research Assistant Jan. 2016-Jun. 2019**

- Design and develop the Tujia virtual dance teaching system based on Kinect
- Propose an algorithm calculating students' dancing performance based on Kinect

Journal Articles (*Corresponding author)

J1. **Yu, S***., Liu, Q*., Jiang, Y., Ma, J., Peng, Y., Ye, R., & Li, P. (2026). Incorporating pedagogical agents into desktop virtual reality: Does visual-tone emotional congruency matter? *Computers & Education*, 254, 105726. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compedu.2026.105726

J2. Gong, X., **Yu, S.*,** Guan, X., & Qiao, A. (2026). Learners' interaction patterns in collaborative programming: an integration of the social epistemic interactions. *Educational Technology & Society,* 29(1), 25-41. doi:10.30191/ETS.202601_29(1).RP02

J3. Gao, Z., Yu, S., Zhao, J., **Yu, S**., Wang, S., & Li, P. (2026). Virtual reality (VR) for language processing and learning: Methods and approaches. *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition*, 1–9. https://doi.org/10.1017/S1366728926101710

J4. Yu, S., Gao, Z., Zhao, J., **Yu, S**., & Li, P. (2026). Immersive Virtual Reality for Second Language Learning. Interdisciplinary Research in Language Science: Yuen Ren Chao's Legacy, 169-194.

J5. Xu, S., Liu, Z., & **Yu, S**. (2026). Effects of Olfactory Cues and Marker Type on Students' Learning and Cognitive Performance in an AR-Based Science Lesson. *International Journal of Human–Computer Interaction*, 0(0), 1–17. https://doi.org/10.1080/10447318.2026.2631668

J6. Ma, J., Li, X., Liu, Q., **Yu, S**., & Liang, Z. (2026). Unveiling the Cognitive and Affective Mechanisms of Virtual Museum Learning: A Partial Least Squares Analysis. *Journal of Educational Computing Research*, 0(46), 1–34. https://doi.org/10.1177/07356331261469084

J7. Shen, Y., Huang, G., Le, H., **Yu, S.**, Xu, M., Ouyang, J., Fan, Y*., Wang, Q. (2025). "Cloud for Youth": An Implementation Research of Cloud-Based Solutions for Bridging the Digital Divide in Rural China. *British Journal of Educational Technology, 00*, 1–25. https://doi.org/10.1111/bjet.70037

J8. Yu, S., Ye, J., Yin, X., Wu, L., **Yu, S.**, Nan, M., & Luo, S. (2025). A learning analytics‐based leaderboard feedback approach for promoting student cognitive engagement and learning performance in online collaborative learning. *British Journal of Educational Technology, 00*, 1–27. https://doi.org/10.1111/bjet.70028

J9. Ma, J., Liu, Q., **Yu, S.**, Liu, J., Li, X., & Wang, C. (2025). What factors influence scientific concept learning? A study based on the fuzzy-set qualitative comparative analysis. *British Journal of Educational Technology, 56*(1), 250–275. https://doi.org/10.1111/bjet.13499

J10. Ma, J., Liu, Q., **Yu, S.**, Li, X., & Liu, J. (2025). Prompting scientific concept learning in augmented reality: impact of the concept map strategy on mental models and cognitive load. *Educational Technology Research and Development*, 0123456789. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11423-025-10470-5

J11. Chen, F., Zhang, S., Liu, Q., **Yu, S.,** Li, X., & Zheng, X. (2025). Supporting learning performance improvement: Role of online group assessment. *Education and Information Technologies*, *30*(1), 1239–1264. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10639-024-12907-5

J12. Gong, X., Xu, W., **Yu, S**., Ma, J., & Qiao, A. (2025). Enhancing computational thinking and spatial reasoning skills in gamification programming learning: A comparative study of tangible, block and paper-and-pencil tools. *British Journal of Educational Technology, 56*(1), 80–102. https://doi.org/10.1111/bjet.13482

J13. **Yu, S.**, Liu, Q., Liu, J., Ma, J., & Yang, Y. (2024). Integrating augmented reality into acoustics learning and examining its effectiveness: a case study of Doppler effect. *Education and Information Technologies, 29*(5), 6319–6340. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10639-023-12091-y

J14. Liu, J., Liu, Q., **Yu, S.**, Ma, J., Liu, M., & Wu, L. (2024). How do autonomy and learner characteristics combine to influence learners' learning outcomes and cognitive load in virtual reality learning environments? A fuzzy-set qualitative comparative analysis approach. *Education and Information Technologies, 29*(1), 77–101. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10639-023-12262-x

J15. Gong, X., **Yu, S***., Xu, J., Qiao, A., & Han, H. (2024). The effect of PDCA cycle strategy on pupils' tangible programming skills and reflective thinking. *Education and Information Technologies, 29*(5), 6383–6405. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10639-023-12037-4

J16. Johnson-Glenberg, M. C., Yu, C. S. P., Liu, F., Amador, C., Bao, Y., **Yu, S**., & LiKamWa, R. (2023). Embodied mixed reality with passive haptics in STEM education: randomized control study with chemistry titration. *Frontiers in Virtual Reality*, *4*(July), 1–20. https://doi.org/10.3389/frvir.2023.1047833

J17. **Yu, S*.**, Liu, Q., Johnson-Glenberg, M. C., Han, M., Ma, J., Ba, S., & Wu, L. (2023). Promoting musical instrument learning in virtual reality environment: Effects of embodiment and visual cues. *Computers & Education*, 198, 104764. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compedu.2023.104764

J18. Liu, Q., Ma, J., **Yu, S.**, Wang, Q., & Xu, S. (2023). Effects of an Augmented Reality-Based Chemistry Experiential Application on Student Knowledge Gains, Learning Motivation, and Technology Perception. *Journal of Science Education and Technology, 32*, 153–167.

https://doi.org/10.1007/s10956-022-10014-z

J19. **Yu, S.**, Liu, Q., Ma, J., Le, H., & Ba, S. (2023). Applying Augmented reality to enhance physics laboratory experience: does learning anxiety matter? *Interactive Learning Environments, 31*(10), 6952–6967. https://doi.org/10.1080/10494820.2022.2057547

J20. Wang, C., & **Yu, S***. (2023). Tablet-to-student ratio matters: Learning performance and mental experience of collaborative inquiry. *Journal of Research on Technology in Education, 55*(4), 646–662. https://doi.org/10.1080/15391523.2021.2015018

J21. Liu, Q., **Yu, S*.,** Chen, W., Wang, Q., & Xu, S. (2021). The effects of an augmented reality based magnetic experimental tool on students' knowledge improvement and cognitive load. *Journal of Computer Assisted Learning, 37*(3), 645–656. https://doi.org/10.1111/jcal.12513

J22. Yang, W., Qingtang, L., Haoyi, H., Hairu, Y., **Shufan, Y.**, Huixiao, L., & Yangyang, Y. (2018). Personal Active Choreographer: Improving the Performance of the Tujia Hand-Waving Dance. *IEEE Consumer Electronics Magazine, 7*(4), 15–25.

Conference Proceedings (* presenter)

C1. **Yu, S***., Liu, Q., Ye, R., Xu, S., Li, P. (2026) Emotional Incongruency in Pedagogical Agents: The Superior Impact of Positive Tone Over Positive Visuals. 2026 American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting. Los Angels, CA. April 2026.

C2. Liu, Q., Sun, L., Ma, J., **Yu, S.,** & Wu, L. (2023). Geometry Wall: An Embodied Gesture-based Game for Supporting Spatial Ability. *2022 IEEE International Conference on Teaching, Assessment and Learning for Engineering (TALE)*, 258–263.

C3. Johnson-Glenberg, M. C., Kapadia, A., Liu, F., Likamwa, R., **Yu, S**., Bennett, A., Kosa, M., Bao, Y., Balanzat, D., & Yu, C. S. P. (2022). *XR - Titration and Civil Engineering: Design Issues & Preliminary Results.* Poster presented at the American Educational Research Association (AERA), San Diego, CA. April 2022.

C4. Liu, J., Liu, Q., **Yu, S**., Ma, J., Liu, M., & Wu, L. (2022). Which Types of Learners Are Suitable for the Virtual Reality Environment: A fsQCA Approach. *2022 8th International Conference of the Immersive Learning Research Network (ILRN)*, 1–5. https://doi.org/10.23919/iLRN55037.2022.9815913

C5. Qingtang, L., Yuwei, J., Jindian, L., Miaomiao, H., Jingjing, M., & **Shufan, Y**. (2021). Design and Implementation of Virtual Sanxian Teaching System. *2021 IEEE International Conference on Engineering, Technology & Education (TALE)*, 938–943. https://doi.org/10.1109/TALE52509.2021.9678770

C6. **Shufan, Y.***, Qingtang, L., Suxiao, X., Yuanyuan, Y., & Linjing, W. (2018). Design and Practice of Exploratory Virtual Experiment in Physics Discipline. *Proceedings of the 2018 IEEE International Conference on Teaching, Assessment, and Learning for Engineering (TALE)*, Wollongong, Australia.

C7. **Yu, s.*,** Liu, Q., Zhang, Y., Wu, L., Le, H. (2018). Research and Design of an Educational Game based on Leap Motion- Miraculous cells. Global Chinese Society for Comoputers in Education Annual meeting (GCCCE 2018), Guangzhou, China.

C8. Liu, Q., **Yu, S**.*, Lin, L., Xu, S., & Wu, L. (2018). Design and Implementation of an Immersive Virtual Reality Biological Courseware—Miraculous Eyeball. *Proceedings of the 2018 International Conference on Blended Learning (ICBL),* Kansai, Japan.

C9. Liu, Q., **Yu, S.***, Wang, Y., Le, H., & Yuan, Y. (2017). A hand-waving dance teaching system based on kinect. *Proceedings of the 2017 International Conference on Blended Learning (ICBL),*

Hong Kong, China.

C10. Liu, Q., Xu, S., **Yu, S.**, Yang, Y., Wu, L., & Ba, S. (2019). Design and implementation of an ar-based inquiry courseware - Magnetic field. *Proceedings of the 2019 International Symposium on Educational Technology (ISET),* Hradec Králové, Czech Republic.

C11. Zhai, X. M., Meng, N., & **Yu, S.** (2019). Investigating Using Behaviors of E-dictionary with Multiple Design: A Perspective from the Integration of Eye-Tracking Technique and Stimulated Recall. *Proceedings of the 2018 IEEE International Conference on Teaching, Assessment, and Learning for Engineering (TALE)*, Wollongong, Australia.

C12. Yang, Y., Liu, Q., Wu, L., Xu, S., **Yu, S.**, & Zhang, N. (2019). Design and development of mobile augmented reality for mathematical experiments. *Proceedings of the 2019 International Symposium on Educational Technology (ISET),* Hradec Králové, Czech Republic.

Manuscript under review

- Ma, J., Liu, Q., **Yu, S**., et al. Promoting knowledge acquisition and psychological experiences through high immersion and low autonomy design: A case study of virtual instrumental culture museum
- Ye, R., Liu, Q., **Yu, S.**, et al. Fast- vs. Slow-Paced Generative AI Peer Agents in Pair Programming: Unfolding Collaborative Dynamics through auto-RQA and Ordered Network Analysis

Software Copyright

- An education game based on Leapmotion -- cellular immunity
- A Tujia Hand-waving dance teaching system based on kinect
- A Tujia Sayeerhe dance teaching system based on kinect
- A virtual experiment platform based on AR technology
- Experimental system of light polarization based on augmented reality technology

Invention Patents (China)

- Liu, Q., **Yu, S.,** Jiang, Y., Han, M., Zhou, S., Ma, J., Wu, L. (2023) A Computational Method and System for an Assemblable Virtual-Real Fusion Experimental Circuit. ZL 2021 1 0813426.9
- Liu, Q., **Yu, S.,** Ma, J., Xu, S., Zheng, X., Yang, W., Wu, L. (2023) A magnetic field visualization method, system, and equipment for virtual-real fusion experiments. ZL 2020 1 1393486.1
- Liu, Q., **Yu, S.,** Li, Y., Zhang, Y., Yuan, Y., Wang, Y., Huang, J., Wu, L. (2021) A teaching method and system for virtual dance. ZL 2018 1 0548334.0
- Liu, Q., Wang, Y., **Yu, S.,** Wu, L., Huang, J., Zhang, Y., Chang, Y., Yuan, Y. (2019) An assessment method for virtual dance system. ZL 2017 1 0774286.2

HONORS AND AWARDS

- National Scholarship for Graduate Students, Ministry of Education of the PRC, 2021.
- First prize, the 3rd "iTeach" National College Students Digital Education Application Innovation Competition, Ministry of Education of the PRC, 2019.
- National Scholarship for Graduate Students, Ministry of Education of the PRC, 2018.

EDITORIAL SERVICE

- **Editorial Board Member**
  - *British Journal of Educational Technology* (IF: 13.0, JCR – Q1), Early Career Researcher Editorial Board, 2026.8-present
- **Guest Editor**
  - *Education Sciences*, Special issue "Reimagining Online Learning: AI-Powered Personalization and Learner-Centered Design" (IF: 3.5, JCR - Q1), 2026.4–present
  - *Frontiers in Psychology* (IF: 3.8, JCR - Q1) & *Frontiers in Virtual Reality* (IF: 3.9) (Joint Topic), Research Topic: "Multisensory Learning: XR, AI, and Cognitive Performance", 2026.7–present

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

- American Education Research Association (AERA)
- Immersive Learning Research Network (iLRN)
- Global Chinese Conference on Computers in Education (GCCCE) 2026, Program Committee Member in C1：Learning Sciences, Educational Neuroscience, and Computer-supported Collaborative Learning
- Global Chinese Conference on Computers in Education (GCCCE) 2027, Program Committee Member in C2：Mobile, Ubiquitous & Contextual Learning

INVITED TALKS

- "Between Virtual-Real: AR, VR and applications in Education," School of Design, Central Academy of Fine Arts (Online). May 2026.
- "Learning in AI era: From brain-model alignment to multimodal instructional interaction," Faculty of Artificial Intelligence in Education, Central China Normal University (Online). April 2026.
- "AR\VR applications in education," School of Education, Huanggang Normal University. HuangGang, Hubei, China. July 2020.
- "How can we apply AR into physics teaching," Chengguan Middle School of Wuchuan, ZunYi, Guizhou. June 2019.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- National Scholarship for Graduate Students, Ministry of Education of the PRC, 2021.
- First prize, the 3rd "iTeach" National College Students Digital Education Application Innovation Competition, Ministry of Education of the PRC, 2019.
- National Scholarship for Graduate Students, Ministry of Education of the PRC, 2018.

REVIEWER

- AERA 2026 annual meeting

- GCCCE 2026
- British Journal of Educational Technology
- Computers & Education
- Computer & Education: X Reality
- Journal of Computer Assisted Learning
- Educational Technology Research & Development
- IEEE transactions on learning technology
- Interactive Learning Environments
- Education and information technologies
- Journal of science education and technology
- Journal of Research on Technology in Education
- Journal of educational computing research
- Universal Access in the Information Society
- International Journal of Human–Computer Interaction

PROFESSIONAL SKILL

- **Specialized software:** SPSS, Visual Studio, Mplus, Photoshop (certified by Adobe), Premiere, 3DS max, Blender. etc
- **Data analysis/model**: GLM, HLM, Network analysis (ENA, ONA), sequential analysis (LSA), machine learning, Biosignal data analysis (Eye Tracking, EDA, fNIRS).
- **Programing language**: C, C #, R, Python, MATLAB, HTML, Jekyll
- **3D game engine**: UNITY
- **XR development:** Vuforia, VR_TK, HTC VIVE motion tracking, VR eye tracking (eye data visualization & analysis)
- **Physiological studies:** Electrodermal activity (EDA), HRV
- **Neural studies**:
  - **fNIRS experiment**: resting state, event-related design, block design, hyperscanning, naturalistic paradigm.
  - **fNIRS data analysis**: Homer2/3 pre-processing, activation analysis, concentration analysis, functional connectivity, WTC, ISC, DCM, graph theory analysis, EEG-fNIRS combination analysis